

How to Use the Author Program

A short step-by-step guide for creating a clear AWS Follow Along.

Simple rule: Author creates the draft. A different Approver checks and publishes it.

CREATE	CHECK	APPROVE	PUBLISH
Author	Preview	Different person	Approver

Start a new Follow Along

1

Open Author

Sign in with the Author account. Open **#author**.

2

Choose Shared Drafts

Select **Shared Drafts** when the work will be reviewed and published.

Tip: Local Drafts stay only in this browser.

3

Create the draft

Select **Create New Follow Along**. Enter the AWS service name, short name and programme title.

4

Open the editor

Select **Create Unpublished Draft**. The 12 Author stages will appear.

Use official AWS documentation while writing. Keep each instruction short and easy to follow.

Save as you go

Moving to the next stage saves the draft. You can also use **Save Draft** at any time.

Plan the learner journey

1

Programme

Describe the service, learner outcome, difficulty, region and total time.

2

Phases

Split the project into a few clear sections. Put them in learner order.

3

Tasks

Add small tasks inside each phase. State the goal, AWS feature and time.

4

Planning Check

Fix every error. Review warnings before moving on.

A task should teach one useful action. If it feels long, split it into two tasks.

Write each task

5

AWS Sources

Add the official AWS documentation used for the task.

6

Instructions

Write Console and/or CLI steps. Give every checkbox its own short instruction.

7

Resources and Checks

Record values the learner must save. Add a simple success check.

Keep instructions short. Tell the learner exactly what to click, enter or confirm.

Finish the content

8

Cleanup

Explain how to remove chargeable resources in reverse order.

9

Authoring Check

Fix all content errors and review any warnings.

Never place passwords, access keys or other secrets in a draft.

Review and send for approval

10**Learner Preview**

Read every task like a learner. Check instructions, checkboxes, saved values and cleanup. Select **Mark Preview Reviewed**.

11**Review**

Add findings if needed. Resolve them, then select **Ready for Approval**.

12**Release Candidate**

Select **Prepare Shared Release Candidate**. A different Approver must review it.

Preparing a candidate does not publish it. The Author cannot approve their own work.

Final quick check

1	Official AWS links added
2	Instructions are short and numbered
3	Checkbox text tells the learner exactly what to do
4	Verification and cleanup are complete
5	Preview reviewed and all errors fixed